CHARACTER BOOKLET · No. 21

Wren Abernathy

GOLDIE'S OLD ROOMMATE

"Ten years away, and you came home to the same old table."



FOR YOUR EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER
JOINS AT 12+ PLAYERS

WHAT TO WEAR

Dress style: a travel-worn trench dress, a scarf from abroad and a stamped passport.

Suit style: a trench coat over a sweater, a scarf from abroad and the same passport.

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Homemade dinner rolls

Store-bought is fine. Bring it in a dish you love and set it by your table tent.

How this booklet works

Before guests arrive: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Appetizers · Round 1: when the host starts Round 1, open page 3.

The Main Course · Round 2: the lower half of page 3.

Pie · Round 3: page 4. Then everyone votes over coffee.

Accusation over coffee: fill in your ballot. Then the truth is read aloud.

Printing? Single-sided, please, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE GATHERING

The tenth annual Friendsgiving at Juniper Barn. Before the meal, cooking-show star Marigold "Goldie" Ashby tasted the first spoonful of gravy from her antique silver gravy boat, said she felt tired, settled into the rocking chair and never woke up. Every guest brought a dish. Every guest had a reason.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

Your Secret Page

You are innocent.

You did not harm Goldie. You may still have something to hide.

If you are not in the game, nothing breaks: the case is fully solvable without this booklet.

Your story and your secret

The famous gravy recipe in the cookbook is your grandmother's, and Goldie never gave you credit. You came home partly to settle that. You texted Goldie last week: "We need to talk at Friendsgiving." You were not even at the barn when the gravy boat was in the pantry. You never hurt anyone.

Where you were (your alibi)

- 5:30–5:58: on the road. At about 5:45 you drove over the Juniper Lane bridge, the last car across before the flooded creek closed it.
- About 5:58: parked in the front lot.
- 6:00: walked in the front door just as Goldie raised the spoon.

Your goal

Clear your name and find out who did this. Keep the gravy recipe story until Round 3.

If someone asks you…

"Where were you at ten to six?" → "Driving. I crossed the bridge at about 5:45, the last car over."

"Why did you text Goldie?" → "An old disagreement. Round 3."

"Did Goldie write to you?" → "Yes, about a hole in the cookbook's bank account."

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

PLAYING TIP

Stay in character and read your Share lines aloud when a round opens. Write down every time you hear on your Detective Notes: someone's story will not match the clock. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet says to share it, but never lie about the evidence.

Appetizers • *Round 1*

ROUND 1 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 1.

Share

- You shared an apartment with Goldie long ago, then lived abroad for ten years.
- You arrived at 6:00, just as Goldie raised the spoon, and the bridge closed behind you.

KEEP QUIET FOR NOW · The gravy recipe story.

Ask

- **Jules:** "How has Goldie been, really?"
- **Avery:** "How did the circle start writing the cookbook?"

Your mission

Ask three guests what has changed in town in the last ten years.

NOTES

✂ CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE HOST

The Main Course • *Round 2*

ROUND 2 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 2.

Share

- Last month Goldie emailed you: "I've found a hole in the cookbook's bank account. Do you know a good accountant?"
- From 5:30 to 5:58 you were driving; you crossed the Juniper Lane bridge at about 5:45.

Ask

- **Morgan:** "Who keeps the cookbook's accounts?"
- **Quinn:** "Has the cookbook money been fair to everyone?"

Your mission

Read Goldie's email line aloud to the group and watch the reactions.

NOTES

Pie • *Round 3*

Read only when the host starts Round 3.

Share

- Your secret: the gravy recipe is your grandmother's and Goldie never credited it. You wanted it fixed, not revenge.
- You weren't even in the barn when the boat sat in the pantry.

Ask

- **Sage:** "Did Goldie ever borrow your recipes too?"
- **Casey:** "Would the show have credited my grandmother?"

Your mission

Offer a dinner roll to the person you most suspect and ask them one last question.

Who's who (public info · optional characters may not be playing)

10 Avery Quill
Barn owner & this year's host · *Roasted pumpkin soup*

11 Sage Montrose
Three-time pie contest champion · *Maple pecan pie*

12 Quinn Delacroix
Owner of Delacroix Cider Mill · *Hot spiced apple cider*

13 Morgan Feld
Cookbook editor · *Cranberry sauce*

14 Casey Thornbury
Producer of Supper with Goldie · *Mushroom stuffing*

15 Jules Carraway
Goldie's cousin · *Cheesy scalloped potatoes*

16 Harper Lindqvist (OPT.)
Farmers' market grower · *Roasted root vegetables*

17 Skyler Bontempo (OPT.)
Food truck owner · *Cornbread*

18 Arden Fairweather (OPT.)
The neighbor next door · *Green bean casserole*

19 Indigo Pike (OPT.)
Turkey farmer · *Roast turkey*

20 Charlie Okonjo (OPT.)
Cheese shop owner · *Autumn cheese board*

21 Wren Abernathy (OPT.)
Goldie's old roommate · *Homemade dinner rolls*

NOTES